



MAKING HEALTH SERVICES AVAILABLE TO THE LESS PRIVILEGED PATIENTS

From my experience in Healthcare over the years-Transformation in Healthcare has always been a continuous on-going process as I have grown in my Career. Healthcare is transforming continuously and I am sure we can accelerate the process towards a more sustainable system in the years to come especially from the knowledge that we have gained in the last decade, wherein we have successfully tackled a pandemic as well and started focusing a lot more on Quality in hospitals. The vision with which one needs to look at Healthcare Transformation has to be driven with the aim of improving quality and lowering cost for the masses on a national scale.



While innovation is essential, we must understand that the approaches we already know that work well with proven results are considered first for implementation in order to scale on a mass level. There is a need to engage the public and private sectors together along with the practitioners, academics, researchers, and consumer groups to find the most effective and efficient models of care throughout the country. The current healthcare system is fragmented over the country and implementing proven approaches is challenging as there are lot of differences in policies and hence the approach must begin at State levels with a more robust mechanism for linkages across different States in order to improve the quality and care throughout the nation.

Another challenge for Healthcare transformation in our country is it is not focused on the value of care that we provide the model has always been a fee for service model and is driven by volumes. Thus the quality, efficiency and focus on reducing costs is strongly reduced and people are not motivated to invest more in preventive care that can help improve health and reduces costs significantly in the long run.

In order to tackle these challenges we must begin with creating a network of organizations in public and private sector that already have established relationships across the healthcare systems and further collaborating with these organizations to develop strategies for change and adoption of proven healthcare strategies on a national scale.

There is a lot of variation and the available

information is not reliable in terms of cost and quality throughout the entire healthcare system, there is a need we take steps to bridge this gap and create more transparency for patients so they are able to take better informed decisions.

As I had mentioned earlier the fee for service model needs to be evolved towards a value-based model and this can be achieved by implementing various value based models, which involve cost sharing based on factors such as risks, interdepartmental costs, bundled services and capitation wherein the short and long term patients share costs on the basis of per month basis by doing contracts etc. with healthcare providers.

In healthcare any technological innovation comes at a very high cost as the research and innovation drives it very high even if the health outcome is marginally improved, hence there is a need to drive innovations to high value solutions so technology

can help in transformation with high quality and less costs.

Healthcare insurance should also be value driven for consumer in order to encourage the consumer to obtain high value care with better outcomes.

Another field that will play a crucial role in Healthcare transformation is Information Technology, with the digital technologies and advent of AI in healthcare, the usage of constantly generated Healthcare data will be more robust and provide more solutions to optimize decision making in Healthcare.

Overall a lot of support will be required from the Government policies as on the above challenges and strategies we need to transform Healthcare at a policy level itself. Government polices will also play a major role to implement transformation in Healthcare across the nation.

